

Security Best Practices for Platform Engineers

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Managing complex networks securely

Platform Engineers are the custodians of the infrastructure that everything else runs on: servers, networks, CI/CD pipelines, and hybrid cloud environments. For this very reason, they represent a prime target for attackers. According to the Verizon Data Breach Investigations Report 2023, 74% of breaches involve the human element — including misconfigurations — making proactive security an absolute priority.

A Platform Engineer's attack surface is broad: from managing TLS certificates to configuring firewalls, from network segmentation to protecting privileged access. A single mistake can open a breach that cascades across all connected systems.

Five essential practices

- Adopt Zero Trust: never trust any device or user by default, even within the corporate perimeter. Always verify identity before granting access.
- Segment networks: isolating critical systems in dedicated VLANs reduces the risk of lateral movement in the event of a compromise.
- Automate patch management: unpatched systems are among the most exploited vulnerabilities. Tools like Ansible or Puppet can automate patching cycles.
- Monitor in real time: implement a SIEM to centralise logs and detect anomalies before they become incidents.
- Protect privileged access (PAM): limit and audit the use of administrative credentials. According to CyberArk, 80% of breaches involve privileged accounts.

Embedding these practices into the infrastructure lifecycle — not as a reactive measure, but as an operational standard — is what distinguishes a resilient platform from a vulnerable one. NetGuard Pro supports Platform Engineers with continuous monitoring, centralised policy management, and automated threat detection, turning security into a competitive advantage.